FIGURE 1.7 Leonard Freed, *West Berlin*, 1961. (Estate of Leonard Freed/Magnum Photos)

After Freed's initial encounters at the Berlin Wall in 1961, he returned to his home in Amsterdam. He told his wife about the single shot at the Berlin Wall and that he wanted to return to America to begin a project on race. This would differ from his work in Europe in exile, tracing the lives of Jewish communities after the Holocaust. Instead, he would step into the role of prodigal white American photographer exploring segregation and his own place within society. In the meantime, Freed continued his work on the German Jews book until after their daughter, Elke Susannah, was born, and they made arrangements to return to the United States. In June 1963, the Freeds took their darkroom enlarger and trays from their Amsterdam flat and packed them into the couple's tiny Fiat 600. They sailed with their car on the Holland America line from Rotterdam to New York. The Freeds stayed in Leonard's childhood home while his parents took Susannah to their cabin in the Catskills for the summer. After the July 4 holiday, Freed got to work. He created an itinerary on ruled notebook paper, detailing dozens of potential photo shoots, with addresses and phone contacts when available.[34] This project, which would eventually become *Black in White America*, thereby began as a series of scheduled photo shoots, portrait sessions, and explorations of his hometown and beyond.

Black in White America emerged from these shoots and other "stories" made during Freed's extended trip throughout the South from 1964 to 1965. The book-length photo-essay captured the persistence of racial division in America in the decade following the 1954 U.S. Supreme Court mandate to end school segregation and through the landmark civil rights legislation of the mid-1960s. Brett Abbott places the photobook at the start of a mid-twentieth-century photographic practice of "engaged" observation, in which Freed's "approach to photojournalism was aimed not so much at telling the details of a particular day or week, but at relating the contours of a bigger, more conceptual narrative about America."[35] Freed's image of one of the many black American GIs at the Berlin Wall is emblematic of a central contradiction of Cold War American culture: a soldier guarding the U.S.-Soviet Cold War front line abroad would, at the same moment, be denied full citizenship rights back home. Through his work on this project—beginning days after the initial construction of the Wall and extending through years of